POLARIZED SYSTEMS LLC
ENTERPRISE NETWORK & SECURITY ENGINEERING

SECURITY OPERATIONS · STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Incident Response Process

Organization: Polarized Systems · **Environment:** corp.polarizedsystems.com · **Owner:** Security Operations
Version: 1.0 · **Last reviewed:** October 2026 · **Aligned to:** NIST SP 800-61 · **Classification:** Internal

1. Purpose & Scope

This procedure defines how Polarized Systems prepares for, detects, contains, recovers from, and communicates security incidents. It applies to any **confirmed or suspected compromise** of the confidentiality, integrity or availability of Polarized Systems systems or data — malware, unauthorized access, privilege escalation, data exfiltration, or denial of service — across the Server, Workstation and Security Operations subnets behind the pfSense firewall.

2. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Incident Response Lead	Owns the incident end to end; declares severity; coordinates the response
Security Analysts	Detection, triage, analysis, containment and eradication
Communications / Stakeholder Liaison	Internal updates and external / regulatory notification where required
System owners	Support containment and recovery of their systems
Management	Authorizes major actions (isolation, takedown); owns risk decisions

3. Severity Classification

Severity	Definition	Example	Response
SEV-1 Critical	Active, widespread, or business-critical impact	Domain-wide ransomware; active exfiltration from a DC	Immediate, all-hands; mgmt + external notification
SEV-2 High	Confirmed compromise, contained scope	Single server compromise; confirmed host malware	Urgent, same-day
SEV-3 Medium	Suspicious but unconfirmed, limited scope	Failed-logon bursts; single phishing click	Standard triage
SEV-4 Low	Policy violation or low-impact event	Isolated policy breach; blocked malware	Routine handling

4. Response Lifecycle

1 · Preparation — Tooling · playbooks · backups → **2 · Detection & Analysis** — Triage · scope · ATT&CK → **3 · Contain / Eradicate / Recover** — Isolate · remove · restore → **4 · Post-Incident** — Lessons learned

- **Preparation** — Maintain the controls that make response possible: centralized logging in **Splunk** (soc-splunk-002) and endpoint detection in **Wazuh** (soc-wazuh-002) across all endpoints, documented playbooks, current asset inventory, and known-good backups.
- **Detection & Analysis** — Identify and validate from Wazuh/Splunk alerts, Windows Security event IDs (e.g. 4625, 4728/4737) and user reports. Confirm a **true positive**, establish scope (hosts, accounts, data), and map activity to **MITRE ATT&CK** to anticipate the attacker's next move. Assign severity and open an incident record with a timeline.
- **Containment, Eradication & Recovery** — **Contain** by isolating hosts via pfSense and disabling compromised accounts, preserving evidence first. **Eradicate** malware, unauthorized accounts, persistence, and the entry vulnerability. **Recover** from known-good backups, confirm clean, and return to production under heightened monitoring.
- **Post-Incident Activity** — Within one week of closure, run a lessons-learned review; feed detection gaps and control changes back into Preparation.

5. Communication & Reporting

Audience	What	When
Internal — IR team & management	Status, severity, actions taken	Continuously through the incident
Internal — affected system owners	Impact and required actions	At containment
External — regulators / CISA / law enforcement	Required notifications per legal/contractual obligation	Per applicable timelines
Leadership — post-incident	Business impact, cost, remediation plan	After closure

External and regulatory reporting is distinct from internal incident reports and is handled by the Communications/Stakeholder Liaison with management approval. Technical findings are translated into **business impact** for leadership — not raw indicators.

6. Tooling & References

Tooling: Wazuh (soc-wazuh-002) for endpoint detection; Splunk (soc-splunk-002) for centralized logging and correlation; pfSense (corp-pfsense-001) for network containment; MITRE ATT&CK for technique mapping; Active Directory for account containment.
References: NIST SP 800-61 (Computer Security Incident Handling Guide) · MITRE ATT&CK Framework · CISA Incident Reporting guidance.